

Feature Documentation Guide

Core Communications

Overview

Core Communications is the foundation of the ParentSquare platform, enabling two-way messaging between schools and families across all channels. All ParentSquare subscriptions include Core Communications.

Key Features

Direct Messaging: Staff can send individual messages to parents, guardians, or students.

Messages thread by conversation for easy tracking.

Post & Newsletter: Create rich-content posts with images, attachments, and event RSVPs. Posts are shared to all families in a class, school, or district.

Group Messaging: Send targeted messages to custom groups (e.g., all Spanish-speaking families, all 3rd-grade families, specific clubs).

Read Receipts: Track which families have opened messages and follow up with unread families.

Attendance Management

Overview

The Attendance Management module automates absence notifications and chronic absenteeism interventions. Districts using this module report an average 3.2% improvement in attendance rates within 6 months of activation.

How It Works

1. SIS sends daily attendance data to ParentSquare (typically by 8:30 AM).
2. ParentSquare identifies absent students and triggers automated alerts.
3. Parents receive a same-day absence notification via their preferred channel.
4. Parent can respond directly to report excused absence.
5. Attendance dashboard shows real-time and trend data for administrators.

Chronic Absenteeism Tracking

Students who miss 10% or more of school days are automatically flagged as chronically absent. The system generates a weekly Chronic Absenteeism Report for school counselors and administrators. Automated intervention sequences can be configured to escalate at 5%, 10%, and 15% absence thresholds.

Mass Notifications & Emergency Alerts

Overview

Send district-wide emergency alerts and mass notifications across all channels simultaneously. Messages are delivered within seconds to thousands of families. Emergency notifications bypass family opt-out preferences.

Use Cases

- School closure (weather, facility emergency).
- Lockdown or shelter-in-place notification.
- Utility outage or delayed opening.
- District-wide event or policy change notification.

School Websites

Overview

Manage ADA-compliant school and district websites directly within ParentSquare. No coding required. Websites automatically surface upcoming events, recent posts, and staff directories.

Accessibility

All ParentSquare websites meet WCAG 2.1 AA standards, including screen reader support, sufficient color contrast, keyboard navigation, and alt text for all images.

Payments & Digital Forms

Overview

Collect payments and digital form signatures within the ParentSquare app. Eliminate paper forms and checks. Supports ACH bank transfer, credit/debit card, and PayPal.

Common Payment Use Cases

- School lunch payments and balance top-ups.
- Activity fees, field trip payments, and club dues.
- Yearbook purchases and merchandise orders.
- Fundraiser collections.

ParentSquare Intelligence

Overview

ParentSquare Intelligence is the AI and data layer embedded across the platform. It surfaces engagement insights, benchmarks performance, and assists staff with communication.

Contactability Benchmark

Compare your district's Contactability Score against anonymized peer districts of similar size and region. The benchmark identifies whether you are above or below average and suggests specific actions to improve.

AI Message Rewrite

Staff can click 'Rewrite with AI' on any draft message to improve tone, clarity, and readability. The AI adjusts reading level, suggests more inclusive language, and improves overall message quality.

Conversation Starters

AI-generated follow-up questions are automatically appended to posts, helping parents engage in home conversations about school content. Staff can review and edit before sending.